COUPLE IN-DEPTH INTERVIEW GUIDE

Demand for Modern Contraception in sub-Saharan Africa: New Methods, New Evidence
In-Depth Interview Guide for Couple Interviews

Ask: *Do you agree to participate in an interview with your spouse or partner?*
If yes, PROCEED. If 'no', thank them for their time and end the interview.

Instructions: The interview will begin with a verbal informed consent process involving acknowledgement that the respondent agrees that the study has been explained to them and that all their questions have been satisfactorily answered, that they have given their consent to be interviewed, and to have the interview audio recorded.

Ask: May I turn on the audio recorder?

After turning on the recorder, say, "Today is ..[date]…, and I am …[name]…This interview is …[say ID]…

Just to confirm, do you give your consent to participate in this interview?

Part 1: Couple's fertility desires and decision-making

I know you have both answered several questions about reasons why people have the number of children they do. But this is a decision that involves both the man and woman. I would like to ask you some questions about how you make decisions about having children as a couple.

I understand you may not always agree on issues. However, for the purpose of this interview, we are interested in all perspectives, whether they are the same or different. To help us to accurately document our conversation, I would appreciate it if you speak one at a time.

1. How many children do you both have together now?

2. Would you like to have any more children?

If at least one respondent says Yes to 2, ask respondent(s) Q3.

3a. What are the specific reasons why you want more children?
[Probe]
**Any other reasons?*

3b. How many more children would you like to have? Why?

[Probe]
**Any other reasons?*

3c. How many more children do you think would be too many for both of you to have? Why?
[Probe]
**Any other reasons?*

3d. How soon would you like to have your next child together? Why?
[Probe]
**Any other reasons?*

If at least one respondent says No to 2, ask respondent(s) Q4.

4. What are your reasons for not wanting any more children?
[Probe]
**Any other reasons?*

Ask all respondents Q5-12

5. Have you ever discussed how many children you want to have together over your entire [marriage/union]? Tell me a bit about the discussion.

If respondents have had a deliberate discussion about how many children to have, ask the following:

a. When in your [marriage/union] did you first begin to discuss having children?
b. What did your early conversations about having children involve?
c. How many children did you each want to have then (when you first started thinking about having children)? Why?

If respondents have not had a deliberate discussion about how many children to have, ask: What are the main reasons why you have not discussed how many children to have? Any other reasons?

6. What discussions have you had on whether to have more children?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
If respondents have discussed having more children, ask:
**When was the most recent time you had this conversation? Tell me about the conversation,* what was discussed?
**Have others been involved in the discussion? Who were those people? What did they say?*
If respondents have not discussed having more children, ask: What are the main reasons why you do not discuss whether or not to have more children? Any other reasons?

7. Whenever you have thought about how many children you would like to have, what were the

main things that you considered?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**Any other things that you thought about?*
**Were there other people whose opinions mattered? Who were they? Why?*
**What about your economic situation?*
**Did your religion influence your thoughts?*

8. Sometimes [spouses/partners] do not agree about having more children. Please imagine the following situations.

a. Suppose you [**refer to:** wife/female partner] want to have more children, but you [**refer to:** husband/male partner] do not want to have any more, how would you decide whether to have more children?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**How would this difference be resolved?*
**Do you think you would have more children or not after resolving the difference? Why?*

b. How about the reverse: suppose you [**refer to:** husband/male partner] want to have more children, but you [**refer to:** wife/female partner] do not want to have any more, how would you decide whether to have more children?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**How would this difference be resolved?*
**Do you think you would have more children or not after resolving the difference? Why?*

9. Suppose, **God forbid,** that as a couple you were unable to have as many children as you both desire.

a. How would you feel about this?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**What do you think would be the negative consequences of not having the number of children you want?*
**What do you think would be the positive consequences of not having the number of children you want?*

b. What would you do about this?
[Follow up questions, if not already answered]
**What actions would you take?*
**Anything else you would do?*

Part 2: Contraception and family planning

Now, I'd like to ask some questions about family planning and contraception

10. What are your thoughts on the role of contraception/family planning in helping couples achieve their desired number of children?

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

If respondents have religious/strong objections to contraception, do not probe further

**Do you think they are helpful or not helpful? Why or why not?*

**Would you recommend contraception/family planning to another couple? Why?*

11. In your [marriage/union], who usually makes the decision on whether to use contraception?

[Probe]

**Can you please explain how these decisions are made?*

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

*Do you [**refer to:** wife/female partner], you [**refer to:** husband/male partner], both of you jointly, or someone else make the decision?

If says someone else: *Who is this person? Why does this person decide?*

12. Do you think you will use any method to delay or avoid pregnancy at any time in the future? *Why/why not?*

[Follow up questions, if not already answered]

**What type(s) would you consider using? Why?*

Thank you very much for the very thoughtful responses you have shared with me today. I really appreciate your patience and feedback. Do you have anything you would like to add that we did not cover during our conversation?

Thank you very much!